

the 1990s, the number of people in the UK who are aged 65 and over has increased by 1.5 million (1990–2000) and is projected to increase by a further 1.5 million by 2020 (Office for National Statistics 2001).

There is a growing awareness of the need to develop strategies to meet the needs of the ageing population. The Department of Health (2000) has identified the need to develop a new model of care for the ageing population, one that is able to meet the needs of the ageing population in a way that is sustainable and cost-effective. The Department of Health (2000) has identified the need to develop a new model of care for the ageing population, one that is able to meet the needs of the ageing population in a way that is sustainable and cost-effective.

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